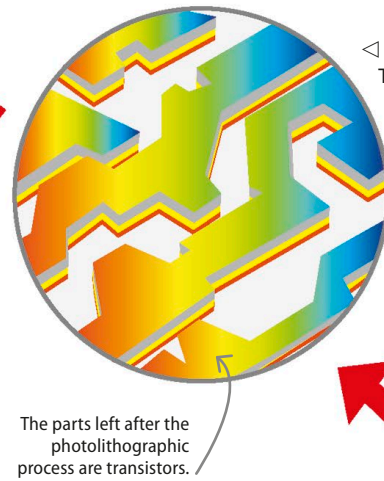
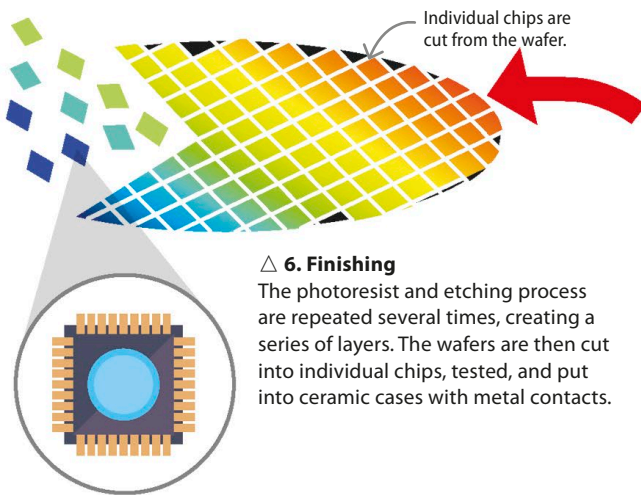




“There was a **space program** before there was **integrated circuits**.”

Jack Kilby (1923–2005), American electrical engineer

IN DEPTH

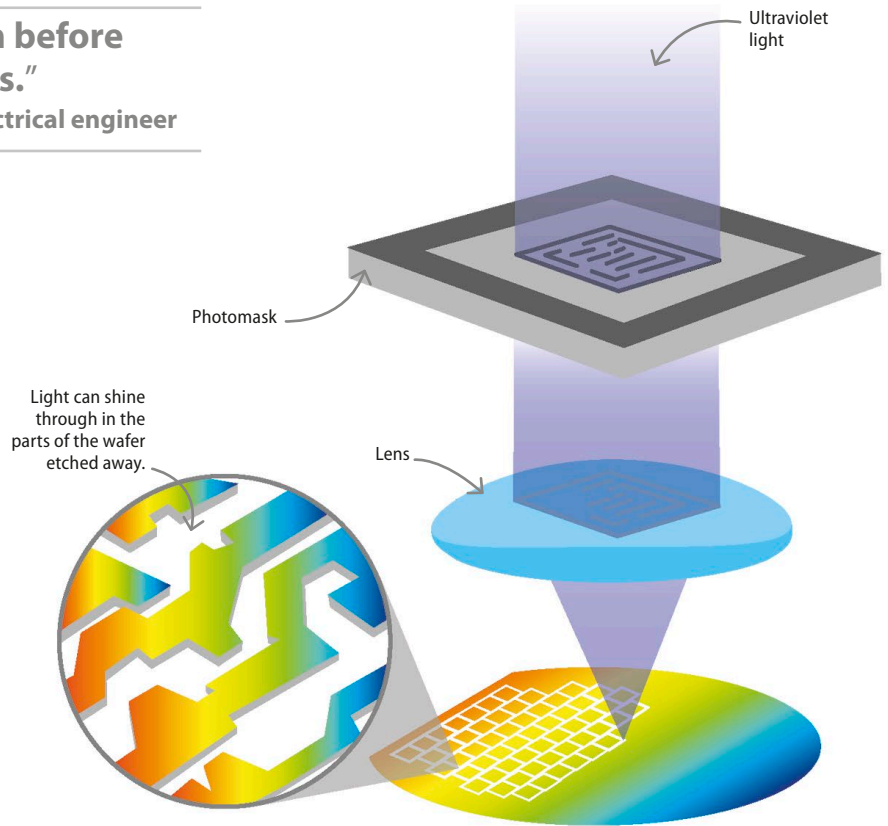
Moore's Law

Moore's Law is an observation made by Gordon Moore (b. 1929), co-founder of microchip company Intel, in 1965. He predicted that the number of transistors in integrated circuits would double roughly every two years. Many experts believe that this doubling of transistors will stop being possible in about 10 years. It's not clear yet if they are right, or what will happen if they are.



△ 3. Photoresist

Each wafer is coated with a substance called photoresist, which protects the wafer from chemicals such as acids. Shining ultraviolet light on an area of the photoresist, however, makes it possible for the chemicals to dissolve that area, revealing the wafer beneath.



△ 4. Mask

The design is turned into a photomask, a bit like a stencil, with some areas removed so that light can shine through them. Masks may be built up in layers, each making up part of the overall pattern.